

Fig. 4.21

The great advantage of knowing properties of quadrilateral is that we can see the relationships among them immediately.

- Every parallelogram is a trapezium, but not necessarily the other way.
- Every rhombus is a parallelogram, but not necessarily the other way.
- Every rectangle is a parallelogram, but not necessarily the other way.
- Every square is a rhombus and hence every square is a parallelogram as well.

For "not necessarily the other way" mathematicians usually say "the converse is not true". A smart question then is: just *when* is the other way also true? For instance, when is a parallelogram also a rectangle? Any parallelogram in which all angles are also equal is a rectangle. (Do you see why?) Now we can observe many more interesting properties. For instance, we see that a rhombus is a parallelogram in which all **sides** are also equal.

Note

You know *bi*-cycles and *tri*-cycles? When we attach *bi or tri* to the front of any word, they stand for 2 (bi) or 3 (tri) of them. Similarly *quadri* stands for 4 of them. We should really speak of quadri-cycles also, but we don't. *Lateral* stands for sideways, thus quadrilateral means a 4-sided figure. You know *trilaterals*; they are also called triangles !
After 4 ? We have: 5 – *penta*, 6 – *hexa*, 7 – *hepta*, 8 – *octa*, 9 – *nano*, 10 – *deca*. Conventions are made by history. Trigons are called triangles, quadrigons are called quadrilaterals. Continuing in th same way we get pentagons, hexagons, heptagons, octagons, nanogons and decagons. Beyond these, we have 11-gons, 12-gons etc. Perhaps you can draw a 23-gon !

4.3.2 More Special Names

When all sides of a quadrilateral are equal, we call it **equilateral**. When all angles of a quadrilateral are equal, we call it **equiangular**. In triangles, we talked of equilateral triangles as those with all sides equal. Now we can call them equiangular triangles as well!

We thus have:

A rhombus is an equilateral parallelogram.

A rectangle is an equiangular parallelogram.

A square is an equilateral and equiangular parallelogram.

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